

# COMPLETE ALGEBRA FORMULA SHEET

## Essential Algebraic Identities, Rules, and Properties

### 1. Laws of Exponents & Logarithms

| Category / Rule   | Formula / Equation                      | Description / Notes                      |
|-------------------|-----------------------------------------|------------------------------------------|
| Product Rule      | $a^m \times a^n = a^{m+n}$              | Add exponents when multiplying same base |
| Quotient Rule     | $a^m / a^n = a^{m-n}$                   | Subtract exponents when dividing         |
| Power of a Power  | $(a^m)^n = a^{m \times n}$              | Multiply exponents                       |
| Negative Exponent | $a^{-n} = 1 / a^n$                      | Reciprocal with positive exponent        |
| Log Product Rule  | $\log_b(xy) = \log_b(x) + \log_b(y)$    | Log of a product is sum of logs          |
| Log Quotient Rule | $\log_b(x / y) = \log_b(x) - \log_b(y)$ | Log of quotient is diff of logs          |
| Log Power Rule    | $\log_b(x^k) = k \cdot \log_b(x)$       | Exponent becomes multiplier              |
| Change of Base    | $\log_b(x) = \log_c(x) / \log_c(b)$     | Convert log base                         |

### 2. Algebraic Identities & Factoring

| Category / Rule       | Formula / Equation                                                                 | Description / Notes            |
|-----------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------|
| Square of a Binomial  | $(a + b)^2 = a^2 + 2ab + b^2$<br>$(a - b)^2 = a^2 - 2ab + b^2$                     | Expansion of binomial squares  |
| Difference of Squares | $a^2 - b^2 = (a - b)(a + b)$                                                       | Product of sum and difference  |
| Cube of a Binomial    | $(a + b)^3 = a^3 + 3a^2b + 3ab^2 + b^3$<br>$(a - b)^3 = a^3 - 3a^2b + 3ab^2 - b^3$ | Binomial expansions to power 3 |
| Sum & Diff of Cubes   | $a^3 + b^3 = (a + b)(a^2 - ab + b^2)$<br>$a^3 - b^3 = (a - b)(a^2 + ab + b^2)$     | Factoring cubic polynomials    |
| Trinomial Square      | $(a + b + c)^2 = a^2 + b^2 + c^2 + 2ab + 2bc + 2ca$                                | Square of three terms          |

### 3. Quadratic Equations & Progressions

| Category / Rule           | Formula / Equation                                          | Description / Notes                          |
|---------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------|
| Quadratic Formula         | $x = [-b \pm \sqrt{b^2 - 4ac}] / 2a$                        | Roots of $ax^2 + bx + c = 0$                 |
| Discriminant ( $\Delta$ ) | $\Delta = b^2 - 4ac$                                        | $>0$ : 2 real, $=0$ : 1 real, $<0$ : complex |
| Vertex Form               | $f(x) = a(x - h)^2 + k$                                     | Vertex is at point (h, k)                    |
| Arithmetic Seq (AP)       | $a_n = a_1 + (n - 1)d$<br>$S_n = (n/2)[2a_1 + (n - 1)d]$    | n-th term & sum of n terms                   |
| Geometric Seq (GP)        | $a_n = a_1 \cdot r^{n-1}$<br>$S_n = a_1(1 - r^n) / (1 - r)$ | n-th term & sum of n terms ( $r \neq 1$ )    |